25901256

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

Fourth SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Value Addition Course (VAC) - MG4VACENG201 - LITERATURE AND LAW

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes Maximum Marks: 50

Part A. MCQ. Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. Foucault argues that disciplines _____ the inconveniences of power.
   Answer: b). magnify [U] / [CO1]
2. In Peter Brooks's analysis which are the two kinds of narratives that cause uncertainty and anxiety to the law? [K] / [CO1]
   Answer: c). confession and victim impact statements
3. Why does the man from the country have to wave to the gatekeeper instead of standing up to ask his final question? [K] / [CO2]
   Answer: b). His body has grown stiff and he can no longer lift himself.
4. How does Hughes change the traditional meaning of the blindfold in his poem “Justice”?
   Answer: a). He shows it hides damage instead of fairness [E] / [CO2]
5. The fact that Goldstein's influence "never seemed to grow less" despite constant refutation suggests: [U] / [CO3]
   Answer: b). The Party may be creating or exaggerating the threat to maintain control

[1x5 = 5]

Part B. SHORT ANSWER. Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

6. Discuss how Peter Brooks says that the use of literature in law becomes a humanizing element. Give illustrations. [U] / [CO1]
   Answer: law often relies on rigid structures and technical language, which can distance it from human experience. Literature introduces narrative, emotion and subjectivity, helping law to understand motives, suffering and moral complexity. For instance, victim testimonies or confessions bring personal voice into legal reasoning. This narrative dimension makes law more empathetic and attentive to lived realities rather than abstract rules.
7. What does Aristotle say about beginnings, middles and ends in stories? [K] / [CO1]
   Answer: well-structured story must have a clear beginning, middle and end. The beginning introduces the action without depending on prior events. The middle develops the action logically. The end provides resolution and follows naturally from earlier events. This structure ensures coherence and completeness in narrative.
8. In "Law Like Love," scholars compare law to clothes and greetings. Why do you think Auden includes these everyday examples? [An] / [CO2]
   Answer: to show that law, like social customs, is embedded in everyday life -- suggest that law is not just a rigid institution but something shaped by human behaviour and relationships -- law functions informally through habits, expectations and mutual recognition.
9. How does Mahasweta Devi’s “Draupadi” help us understand the everyday life of tribal communities under state control? [An] / [CO2]
   Answer: exposes the harsh realities faced by tribal communities -- surveillance, military violence and exploitation as part of daily existence – Draupadi’s experience reflects systemic oppression where law becomes a tool of control rather than justice
10. Analyze the ethical responsibilities of advocates as depicted in the film Nna Thaan Case Kodu [An] / [CO3]
    Answer: advocates as responsible for ensuring fairness and access to justice -- highlights integrity, commitment to truth and duty towards clients -- shows how some lawyers manipulate procedures for personal gain -- ethical advocacy requires both professional competence and moral responsibility
11. Discuss how the film Nna Thaan Case Kodu critiques systemic inefficiency in governance. [K] / [CO3]

Answer: Minor issues escalate because institutions fail to respond effectively. Legal processes appear slow and disconnected from public needs. Through satire, the film reveals how inefficiency in governance undermines justice and everyday life.

12. Analyse the statement "Orthodoxy was unconsciousness." What does this reveal about the Party's ultimate goal? [An] / [CO3]
    Answer: 1984 - Party's goal -- eliminate independent thought. Citizens are expected to accept ideology without questioning. Orthodoxy becomes automatic -- a system where control is internalised, making resistance almost impossible
13. Explain Syme's statement: "Don't you see that the whole aim of Newspeak is to narrow the range of thought?" How does language relate to consciousness and freedom? [An] / [CO3]
    Answer: Newspeak reduces vocabulary to limit the ability to think critically. If words for rebellion or dissent do not exist, such ideas cannot be expressed or even conceived. Language shapes consciousness, so restricting language restricts freedom. This reflects the Party's aim to control both thought and reality.
14. Analyse how the minister's character represents institutional authority. [An] / [CO3]
    Answer: minister represents detached and authoritarian power. He symbolises institutions that prioritise control over justice. His actions reflect bureaucracy, indifference and misuse of authority. Through this character, the text critiques how institutions can become oppressive when they lack accountability

[5x6 = 30]

Part C. ESSAY. Answer any 1 question. Each question carries 15 marks

15. According to Foucault disciplinary power reduces the inefficiency caused by huge numbers or multiplicities, and establishes control over management of people and resources. Discuss. [U] / [CO1]
    Answer: Foucault explains that modern power works through discipline rather than force. Institutions regulate behaviour using surveillance, routines and classification. The Panopticon symbolises constant observation, making individuals self-regulate.
    Disciplinary systems organise large populations efficiently by producing knowledge about them. Examinations and records define norms and control behaviour. This reduces inefficiency but limits freedom, as people internalise control and become obedient subjects.
16. Analyse the ending of 'Marrying the Hangman'. [An] / [CO2]
    Answer: The ending is ironic. The woman avoids execution but remains trapped in a patriarchal system. Her marriage ensures survival, not freedom -- Atwood shows how law can reinforce power structures. The woman's body becomes a site of negotiation, exposing the limits of justice. The ending suggests that legal outcomes may not ensure autonomy.
17. Examine the pervasive irony in the names and functions of Oceania's four ministries. What is Orwell satirizing about government bureaucracy, propaganda, and the corruption of language in political systems? How does this irony contribute to the novel's dystopian vision? [A] / [CO3]
    Answer: Each ministry's name contradicts its function. Truth spreads lies, Peace conducts war, Love enforces torture, and Plenty manages scarcity. This irony shows how language is manipulated to distort reality. Orwell critiques political systems that use propaganda and bureaucracy to control thought. The result is a dystopia where truth is unstable and obedience is ensured through linguistic control.

[15x1 = 15]